

# Book Reviews

## Annotated Example of a Book Review

Purpose: To review a book and inform other readers.

### Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

By Lewis Carroll

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland was written by Lewis Carroll in 1865. Born Charles Lutwidge Dodgson, Carroll had ten siblings and often made up stories and games to entertain them. At university, he used to look after the children of other staff and one day told the story of Alice to three children. They enjoyed it so much they asked him to write it down – so Carroll did. When he died in 1898, Alice's Adventures in Wonderland was the most popular children's book in England and is still one of the most well-known stories for children today. (1)

The story is about Alice and her adventures in a fantastical place called Wonderland. Alice stumbles across Wonderland by following the White Rabbit down his rabbit hole and her adventures begin. In Wonderland, she goes on lots of little adventures on her way, trying to get home, and learns that it's important not to take anything as it seems, because everything is not as it looks! The protagonist, Alice, is a young girl who is quite clever and very fond of her cat. She thinks a lot, both out loud and to herself. The antagonist is the Queen of Hearts, who has a horrible temper and terrifies almost everyone in Wonderland. She is known for her catchphrase, "off with their heads!"

(5) The Cheshire Cat is one of the most helpful characters on Alice's adventure, as he turns up and gives her advice when she needs it most: (2)

"Would you tell me, please, which way I ought to go from here?"

"That depends a good deal on where you want to get to," said the Cat.

(1) Background Information

(2) General Information

(3) Your Opinion/Analysis

(4) First Person

(5) Supporting Evidence

(6) Rating

(7) Descriptive and Opinion-Based Language Paragraphs

"I don't much care where —" said Alice.

"Then it doesn't matter which way you go," said the Cat. (5)

I enjoyed (4) this book because it is nonsense. It is a nice escape from real life into Wonderland, and I think (4) anyone who is feeling stressed about things would enjoy it. It was hard to read sometimes because of the time it was written — the language is a lot more formal than what we use today, so because of this I would (4) recommend the book to readers about 10 years old and up, or be read to by a grown up. Lewis Carroll set out to entertain children with this story, and I think (4) he did well. The proof of this is that his book has been one of the most popular children's stories for more than a hundred years — it is so popular that even Disney made a film about it! Mostly I thought this story made sense as I read it, but sometimes I thought it was missing some structure along the way. (4) I usually (4) read fantasy novels where the protagonist is on a quest, and Alice is really just on a series of fantastical adventures with no real aim. (3) I did enjoy that it was ridiculous, though, and it reminded me not to take things so seriously. (4)

I give (4) this book 4/5 stars. (6)